

TERMEZ STATE UNIVERSITY

Policy for Equal Opportunities

Approved by the Academic Council and the Rectorate of Termez State University. This Policy sets out the University's commitment to equal opportunities, non-discrimination and inclusion for all members of the University community.

Termez, Republic of Uzbekistan

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Preamble

Termez State University is a community of scholars, students and staff united by a shared commitment to knowledge, integrity and service. The University recognises that its strength as a centre of higher education, research and regional development depends on its ability to attract, develop and retain talented people from every background, and to treat every member of its community with fairness, dignity and respect.

This Policy for Equal Opportunities (hereinafter "the Policy") articulates the principles, structures and procedures through which the University

gives effect to that commitment. It applies alongside the University's Code of Ethics and Internal Personnel Regulations, its Charter, and the collective body of national legislation on education, labour and equal rights, and it is intended to be read together with those instruments rather than in isolation from them.

The University understands equal opportunities not as a slogan but as a continuous institutional practice: a set of concrete measures in recruitment, teaching, assessment, promotion, remuneration, campus design and governance that, taken together, ensure that a person's sex, ethnicity, disability, socio-economic background, age, religion, family status or other personal characteristic never becomes a barrier to their contribution to, or benefit from, university life.

This Policy was developed with the participation of representatives from across the University community, including academic and administrative staff, student self-government bodies, and the Women's Advisory Board, in recognition of the fact that a policy on equal opportunities is most effective when it is shaped by the people whose working and learning lives it is meant to protect and improve.

PART I. GENERAL PROVISIONS

Article 1. Purpose and Objectives

1.1. The purpose of this Policy is to establish a comprehensive and coherent framework through which Termez State University guarantees equal opportunities and equal treatment to all students, academic staff, administrative staff, contractors and visitors, regardless of personal characteristics unrelated to merit, conduct or ability.

1.2. The objectives of the Policy are: to prevent and eliminate discrimination in all forms of University activity; to promote the fair and transparent treatment of individuals in recruitment, admission, assessment, promotion and remuneration; to ensure that persons with disabilities, women, students from disadvantaged backgrounds and other underrepresented groups have genuine and effective access to the University's programmes, facilities and career pathways; to build an institutional culture in which diversity is treated as a source of academic and organisational strength; and to provide clear, accessible mechanisms through which concerns about unequal treatment can be raised, investigated and resolved.

1.3. This Policy is a living document. It will be reviewed periodically, and amended as necessary, to reflect developments in national legislation, international good practice, and the University's own experience of implementing equal opportunities in practice.

1.4. Nothing in this Policy shall be interpreted as diminishing rights or protections that members of the University community enjoy under the Constitution and laws of the Republic of Uzbekistan; where such laws provide a higher standard of protection than this Policy, the higher standard shall prevail.

1.5. In implementing this Policy, the University will pay particular attention to the intersection of protected characteristics, recognising that individuals may experience compounded disadvantage where, for example, disability intersects with gender, or socio-economic hardship intersects with rural origin, and will design support measures with this intersectionality in mind rather than treating each characteristic as though it operated in isolation from the others.

Article 2. Scope of Application

2.1. This Policy applies to all faculties, institutes, departments, chairs, administrative units, dormitories, laboratories and other structural subdivisions of Termez State University, including any branch or affiliated unit that may be established in the future.

2.2. This Policy applies to all categories of persons associated with the University, including: bachelor's, master's and doctoral students; rectorate members, deans, heads of department and other managers; professors, associate professors, lecturers, researchers and teaching assistants; administrative, technical, library and support staff; job applicants and candidates for admission; visiting scholars, exchange students and guest lecturers; and contractors, vendors and other third parties while performing work on University premises or under University auspices.

2.3. The Policy applies to all forms of University activity, including but not limited to admission and enrolment, curriculum design and delivery, examinations and assessment, academic advising, research supervision, employment and human resource management, disciplinary proceedings, allocation of scholarships and financial aid, use of campus facilities, participation in extracurricular activities, and representation of the University at external events.

2.4. Where the University enters into partnership, exchange or cooperation agreements with other institutions, it will encourage partner institutions to observe comparable equal-opportunity standards, and will take this Policy into account when assessing the suitability of prospective partners.

2.5. This Policy applies equally to activities conducted on the main campus of the University and to activities conducted at any field site, practicum placement, internship host organisation, or off-campus event organised or endorsed by the University, to the extent that the University is able to exercise influence over the conditions of such activities.

Article 3. Legal and Regulatory Framework

3.1. This Policy is grounded in, and gives institutional effect to, the equality guarantees of the Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan, in particular the guarantee that all citizens shall have equal rights and freedoms and shall be equal before the law without distinction as to sex, race, nationality, language, religion, social origin, beliefs, or individual or social status.

3.2. This Policy takes into account the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Education", the Law "On Guarantees of Equal Rights and Opportunities for Women and Men", the Law "On the Protection of Women from Oppression and Violence", the Labour Code of the Republic of Uzbekistan, the Law "On the Rights of Persons with Disabilities", and the Law "On the National Programme for Personnel Training", together with the by-laws, resolutions and decrees issued pursuant to them.

3.3. The University also has regard to relevant international instruments to which the Republic of Uzbekistan is a party, including the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, and draws on

international good practice in higher-education equality management, including the equality-policy frameworks used by partner universities abroad.

3.4. This Policy operates within, and does not override, the University's Charter, its Code of Ethics and Internal Personnel Regulations, and its collective bargaining and labour agreements. Where a conflict is identified between this Policy and another internal instrument, the matter shall be referred to the Rectorate for resolution, applying the standard most protective of equal treatment.

3.5. The University shall maintain ongoing awareness of amendments to the legislative instruments listed in this Article, and the University's legal service, in cooperation with the Equal Opportunities Committee, shall issue periodic guidance to academic and administrative units to ensure that this Policy and its implementing procedures remain consistent with the current state of national law and with any newly ratified international obligations of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

Article 4. Definitions

4.1. For the purposes of this Policy, the following terms shall have the meanings set out below.

4.2. "Discrimination" means any distinction, exclusion, restriction or preference based on sex, race, ethnicity, nationality, language, religion, disability, age, social origin, property status, marital or family status, political or other opinion, or any other characteristic unrelated to a person's professional or academic merit, that has the purpose or effect of impairing or nullifying the recognition, enjoyment or exercise of rights and opportunities on an equal footing.

4.3. "Direct discrimination" means treating a person less favourably than another person is, has been, or would be treated in a comparable situation, because of a protected characteristic. "Indirect discrimination" means applying an apparently neutral provision, criterion or practice that would put persons sharing a protected characteristic at a particular disadvantage compared with other persons, unless that provision, criterion or practice is objectively justified by a legitimate aim and the means of achieving it are appropriate and necessary.

4.4. "Harassment" means unwanted conduct related to a protected characteristic that has the purpose or effect of violating a person's dignity, or of creating an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating or offensive environment. "Sexual harassment" means any form of unwanted verbal, non-verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature that has the purpose or effect described above.

4.5. "Reasonable accommodation" means necessary and appropriate modification and adjustment, not imposing a disproportionate or undue burden on the University, made where needed in a particular case to enable a person with a disability to enjoy or exercise, on an equal basis with others, all rights and opportunities available at the University.

4.6. "Protected characteristic" means any of the personal characteristics identified in Article 3 and Article 27 of this Policy in respect of which discrimination is prohibited, including sex, gender, pregnancy and maternity, marital and family status, race and ethnicity, nationality, language, religion or belief, disability, age, and social or economic origin.

4.7. "Underrepresented group" means a group of students, staff or applicants whose participation in a particular programme, discipline, grade level or leadership position is demonstrably lower than would be

expected given their representation in the wider applicant or population pool, and for whom targeted support measures may be justified.

4.8. "Retaliation" or "victimisation" means any adverse treatment of a person because that person has made, supported, or provided information in relation to, a complaint of discrimination or harassment under this Policy, or has otherwise exercised a right protected by this Policy.

4.9. "Equal Opportunities Committee" and "Women's Advisory Board" refer to the bodies described in Articles 10 and 11 of this Policy, respectively.

4.10. "Structural subdivision" means any faculty, institute, department, chair, administrative directorate, dormitory, centre, laboratory or other organisational unit of the University, however named, and references in this Policy to a structural subdivision shall be construed accordingly.

4.11. "Applicant" means a person who has submitted, or has taken a documented step towards submitting, an application for admission to a programme of study or for a vacant post at the University, and who is thereby entitled to the protections against discrimination described in this Policy from the point of application onward.

PART II. GUIDING PRINCIPLES AND POLICY STATEMENT

Article 5. Commitment to Equal Opportunities

5.1. Termez State University is committed to fostering an inclusive environment that guarantees equal opportunities for all members of the academic community, regardless of gender, background, or physical ability. This commitment is not aspirational language alone; it is embedded in the University's governance structures, its budgeting decisions, its recruitment practices and its day-to-day academic administration.

5.2. The University's approach to equal opportunities is governed by both national legislation and internal institutional policies, which are systematically implemented through policy integration, inclusive recruitment and career development, student support and accessibility measures, and structured monitoring and implementation, as elaborated throughout this Policy.

5.3. The University's leadership, from the Rector to the head of every chair and department, bears personal responsibility for modelling the standards of fairness and inclusion that this Policy describes, and for ensuring that those standards are observed by staff and students under their supervision.

5.4. The University will not tolerate discrimination, harassment or victimisation by any member of its community, whatever their seniority, and will apply this Policy consistently regardless of a person's position, length of service, or academic standing.

5.5. The University regards its commitment to equal opportunities as inseparable from its academic mission: a university that draws talent from

the widest possible pool, and enables every member of its community to contribute fully, is better placed to produce strong teaching, meaningful research and graduates equipped to serve the country's development.

Article 6. Guiding Principles

6.1. Equality of opportunity. Every person associated with the University shall have a genuine and equal opportunity to participate in, contribute to, and benefit from University life, judged on the basis of ability, effort and merit rather than on the basis of personal characteristics unrelated to those factors.

6.2. Non-discrimination. No person shall be disadvantaged, excluded or treated less favourably on the grounds of a protected characteristic in any decision relating to admission, employment, promotion, remuneration, academic assessment, disciplinary treatment, or access to University facilities and services.

6.3. Inclusion. The University will proactively design its programmes, facilities, communications and processes so that they are usable by, and welcoming to, the widest practicable range of people, rather than relying solely on individual accommodation requests after the fact.

6.4. Proportionality and reasonable accommodation. Where a measure is needed to enable a person with a disability, a caring responsibility or another relevant circumstance to participate on an equal footing, the University will provide reasonable accommodation, having regard to the needs of the individual and the resources reasonably available to the University.

6.5. Transparency and accountability. Decisions affecting admission, employment, promotion and remuneration will be based on clear,

published criteria, and the bodies responsible for equal opportunities will report regularly on their activities and findings.

6.6. Participation. Students and staff, including through their representative bodies, will be consulted on the design and review of equal-opportunity measures that affect them, so that this Policy remains grounded in the lived experience of the University community.

6.7. Confidentiality and protection from retaliation. Individuals who raise concerns in good faith about discrimination or harassment will be protected from retaliation, and their personal information will be handled with the strictest practicable confidentiality consistent with a fair investigation.

6.8. Continuous improvement. The University treats equal opportunities as a field of continuous institutional learning rather than a fixed set of rules, and will adjust its measures in light of monitoring data, comparative experience with partner institutions, and the evolving needs of its own community, rather than regarding this Policy as a document to be filed away once approved.

Article 7. Protected Characteristics

7.1. This Policy prohibits discrimination on the grounds of, among other characteristics: sex and gender; pregnancy, maternity and paternity; marital, family or parental status; race, ethnicity and national or social origin; language; religion or belief; disability, including physical, sensory, intellectual and psychosocial disability; age; health status, including HIV status; and social or economic origin, including status as an orphan, a person from a low-income household, or a person from a rural or remote area.

7.2. The list in Article 7.1 is illustrative and not exhaustive. The Equal Opportunities Committee may, by reasoned decision and in consultation with the Rectorate, recognise an additional characteristic as falling within the scope of this Policy where evidence demonstrates that persons sharing that characteristic experience a comparable pattern of disadvantage within the University.

7.3. Protection under this Policy extends to a person who is discriminated against because of an actual, perceived, or previously held protected characteristic, and to a person who is discriminated against because of their association with another person who holds a protected characteristic.

7.4. The University shall keep the list of characteristics addressed by targeted support measures under active review, drawing on the monitoring data described in Article 40 and on direct consultation with student and staff representative bodies, so that emerging patterns of disadvantage are identified as early as practicable rather than only after they have become entrenched.

PART III. GOVERNANCE AND INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK

Article 8. Policy Framework and Integration

8.1. The University's commitment to equality is formally integrated into the University's Code of Ethics and internal personnel regulations. These documents explicitly prohibit any form of discrimination and establish clear pathways for reporting and addressing grievances, and this Policy elaborates and operationalises those commitments in greater detail.

8.2. Every new internal regulation, order, programme document or administrative instruction issued by the University shall be reviewed for consistency with this Policy before adoption. Where a proposed measure risks creating or perpetuating unequal treatment, the unit proposing it shall consult the Equal Opportunities Committee before proceeding.

8.3. This Policy shall be referenced in the University's strategic development plan, its annual work plans, and the performance agreements of senior managers, so that equal-opportunity objectives are treated as a standing institutional priority rather than a peripheral concern.

8.4. The University budget shall include, where necessary, dedicated resources to support the implementation of this Policy, including accessibility improvements, translation and interpretation services, staff training, and the operation of the bodies described in Articles 10 and 11.

8.5. Where the University adopts a new academic programme, opens a new faculty or department, or undertakes a significant reorganisation of its structure, the planning process for that change shall include an assessment of its implications for equal opportunities, so that the Policy is applied prospectively rather than only retrospectively to problems that have already arisen.

Article 9. Roles and Responsibilities of the Rector and Rectorate

9.1. The Rector bears overall responsibility for ensuring that Termez State University complies with this Policy and with applicable legislation on equal rights and opportunities.

9.2. The Rectorate shall approve the annual equal-opportunities work plan prepared by the Equal Opportunities Committee, allocate the resources necessary for its implementation, and review, at least annually, the reports and recommendations submitted under Article 41.

9.3. The Vice-Rector for Academic Affairs, the Vice-Rector for Scientific Affairs, the Vice-Rector for Youth Affairs and Spiritual-Educational Work, and other members of the Rectorate shall each be responsible for the implementation of this Policy within their respective areas of authority, and shall designate a senior staff member within their portfolio as a point of contact for equal-opportunities matters.

9.4. The Rectorate shall ensure that this Policy, and any material amendment to it, is communicated to the entire University community in accessible language and, where appropriate, in both the State language and other languages spoken by significant numbers of students or staff.

9.5. The Rector shall present a summary of the University's performance under this Policy to the University's founding or supervisory authority, as applicable, as part of the University's regular institutional reporting obligations, and shall ensure that equal-opportunities performance is treated as a relevant factor in the periodic external evaluation and accreditation of the University.

Article 10. The Equal Opportunities Committee

10.1. The University shall maintain a standing Equal Opportunities Committee, chaired by a Vice-Rector or a senior official designated by the Rector, and composed of representatives of the faculties, the Human Resources Department, the Student Affairs Office, the trade union or staff representative body, the student self-government body, and, where practicable, external experts in equality and non-discrimination.

10.2. The Equal Opportunities Committee shall: oversee the implementation of this Policy across the University; review complaints escalated to it under Article 35; recommend policy improvements to the Rectorate; approve the annual equal-opportunities work plan and monitor its execution; and coordinate the collection and analysis of the data described in Article 40.

10.3. The Committee shall meet not less than once per academic quarter, and shall keep minutes of its meetings, which shall be available to members of the University community upon reasoned request, subject to the confidentiality protections described in Article 37.

10.4. Membership of the Committee shall be renewed periodically, and shall so far as practicable itself reflect the diversity of the University community, including a reasonable balance of men and women and representation of academic and administrative staff and students.

10.5. The Equal Opportunities Committee shall have the authority to request relevant information and documentation from any structural subdivision of the University in connection with its monitoring and oversight functions, and structural subdivisions shall cooperate promptly with such requests.

Article 11. The Women's Advisory Board

11.1. Responsibility for overseeing gender-equality measures at the University lies with a dedicated structural unit, the Women's Advisory Board, working alongside the Student Affairs Office and the Equal Opportunities Committee described in Article 10.

11.2. The Women's Advisory Board shall be composed of women academic and administrative staff, women students, and, where appropriate, external advisors with relevant expertise, and shall be chaired by a senior woman official appointed by the Rector.

11.3. The Women's Advisory Board shall: advise the Rectorate on measures to improve the recruitment, retention, career progression and wellbeing of women staff and students; monitor the representation of women in leadership positions, academic ranks and specialisations where women remain underrepresented; propose mentoring, training and networking programmes for women; and receive and, where appropriate, refer for formal investigation concerns relating to gender-based discrimination or harassment.

11.4. The University regularly monitors the representation and engagement of different groups through participation data and survey feedback, which are integrated into the University's annual institutional reports, and the Women's Advisory Board shall be a principal contributor to the gender-related components of that monitoring.

11.5. The Women's Advisory Board shall submit an annual report of its activities and recommendations to the Rectorate and to the Equal Opportunities Committee, which shall be considered alongside the report described in Article 41.

11.6. The Women's Advisory Board shall maintain contact with counterpart bodies at other higher education institutions of the Republic of Uzbekistan and, where possible, abroad, in order to exchange experience on the practical implementation of gender-equality measures in a university setting, and shall bring relevant good practice to the attention of the Rectorate and the Equal Opportunities Committee.

Article 12. Role of Deans, Heads of Department and Line Managers

12.1. Deans, heads of department and chairs, and other line managers are the first line of implementation of this Policy. They are responsible for the day-to-day fairness of decisions within their units, including workload allocation, timetabling, academic supervision assignments, and informal resolution of minor concerns.

12.2. Managers shall bring concerns raised informally to their attention to a prompt and fair resolution wherever possible, shall refer matters that cannot be resolved informally to the appropriate channel described in Article 34, and shall never discourage or penalise a person for raising a concern in good faith.

12.3. Managers shall complete the training described in Article 42 and shall be evaluated, as part of their regular performance review, on their contribution to a fair and inclusive working and learning environment within their unit.

12.4. A manager who becomes aware of a possible violation of this Policy within their unit, whether or not a formal report has been made, shall take reasonable steps to address the situation and, where appropriate, to bring it to the attention of the Human Resources Department or the Equal Opportunities Committee.

Article 13. Role of the Human Resources Department

13.1. The Human Resources Department is responsible for ensuring that recruitment, appointment, remuneration, promotion and disciplinary procedures are designed and applied in accordance with this Policy, and for maintaining accurate, disaggregated personnel data to support the monitoring described in Article 40.

13.2. The Human Resources Department shall review job announcements, selection criteria and interview procedures for consistency with the principles of inclusive recruitment described in Article 15, and shall provide guidance to selection panels on avoiding unconscious bias.

13.3. The Human Resources Department shall maintain a confidential record of complaints received, investigations conducted and outcomes reached under this Policy, in a manner that protects the identities of complainants and respondents while enabling meaningful statistical analysis.

13.4. The Human Resources Department shall, at least once per year, review the University's job classification and remuneration structures to confirm that they remain free of embedded assumptions that could disadvantage a particular group, such as classification practices that undervalue roles predominantly performed by women.

Article 14. Role of the Student Affairs Office

14.1. The Student Affairs Office shall be the principal point of contact for students seeking information, advice or support in relation to equal opportunities, and shall work closely with the Women's Advisory Board and the Equal Opportunities Committee.

14.2. The Student Affairs Office is responsible for coordinating accessible learning infrastructure, social scholarship programmes, and designated support units for students with special needs or those requiring socio-economic assistance, as further described in Part V of this Policy.

14.3. The Student Affairs Office shall maintain confidential records of the support provided to individual students, and shall use aggregated, anonymised data from those records to inform the University's annual reporting under Article 41.

14.4. The Student Affairs Office shall organise a structured orientation session on equal opportunities and available support services for every incoming cohort of students, delivered in cooperation with the Women's Advisory Board and, where relevant, the support units described in Article 24.

PART IV. EQUAL OPPORTUNITIES IN EMPLOYMENT

Article 15. Inclusive and Gender-Neutral Recruitment

15.1. The University implements gender-neutral recruitment practices at every stage of the employment cycle, from the drafting of vacancy announcements through to the final selection decision.

15.2. Vacancy announcements shall describe the genuine requirements of the post in terms of qualifications, experience and competencies, and shall avoid language, imagery or criteria that discourage applications from any group on the basis of a protected characteristic.

15.3. Selection panels shall, so far as practicable, be composed of both men and women, and panel members shall receive guidance on objective, criteria-based assessment before participating in selection decisions.

15.4. Where two or more candidates for a post are assessed as substantially equally qualified, the University may take into account the objective of improving the representation of an underrepresented group within the relevant unit, provided that this is done transparently, consistently with the principle of merit, and in a manner consistent with applicable law.

15.5. The University will maintain and publish, on an anonymised and aggregated basis, statistics on the gender composition of applicant pools, shortlists and appointees, so that progress towards inclusive recruitment can be tracked over time.

15.6. Probationary evaluation of newly appointed staff shall be conducted against the same criteria communicated to the candidate at the time of appointment, and a probationary decision shall not be influenced by a

protected characteristic that emerged or became known only after appointment, such as pregnancy, marriage, or a declared disability.

15.7. Interview questions shall relate exclusively to the requirements of the post and the candidate's suitability for it; questions concerning a candidate's marital status, family planning intentions, or similar personal matters unrelated to the requirements of the post shall not be asked.

Article 16. Equal Pay and Benefits

16.1. The University shall ensure that remuneration, allowances and other benefits are determined by objective, published criteria relating to qualifications, experience, workload, rank and performance, and shall not differ between persons performing work of equal value because of a protected characteristic.

16.2. The Human Resources Department shall periodically audit salary and benefit data, disaggregated by sex and other relevant characteristics where lawful and appropriate, to identify and correct any unexplained disparities.

16.3. Access to housing assistance, travel allowances, health benefits and other forms of institutional support shall be governed by criteria applied equally to all eligible staff, regardless of protected characteristics.

16.4. A staff member who believes that they are receiving unequal pay for work of equal value because of a protected characteristic may raise the matter confidentially with the Human Resources Department or, if they prefer, directly with the Equal Opportunities Committee, and shall not be penalised in any way for doing so.

Article 17. Career Development and Promotion

17.1. The University promotes professional development opportunities for all staff, ensuring that HR management processes are designed to guarantee fair access to training, promotion, and leadership roles.

17.2. Criteria for academic and administrative promotion shall be published, applied consistently, and shall not directly or indirectly disadvantage staff who have taken parental leave, worked part-time for caring reasons, or experienced a career interruption for reasons related to a protected characteristic.

17.3. The University shall monitor the proportion of women and other underrepresented groups among candidates for, and recipients of, academic titles, administrative promotions and leadership appointments, and the Women's Advisory Board and Equal Opportunities Committee shall jointly propose corrective measures where significant and persistent disparities are identified.

17.4. The University shall support mentoring and leadership-development programmes designed to prepare women and other underrepresented staff for senior academic and administrative roles.

17.5. Where a member of academic staff is required to defend a dissertation, prepare an application for an academic title, or undertake other career-defining academic milestones, the University shall ensure that the deadlines and workload expectations attached to such milestones do not systematically disadvantage staff with significant caring responsibilities, and shall consider reasonable extensions upon documented request.

17.6. Committees responsible for the award of academic titles, research grants and internal prizes shall apply published, criteria-based

procedures, and shall periodically review the gender and other relevant composition of nominees and recipients to identify any unexplained pattern of disparity.

Article 18. Access to Training and Professional Development

18.1. All staff shall have equal access to internal and external training, conference attendance, research grants and sabbatical opportunities, allocated according to transparent, merit-based criteria that take into account the availability of such opportunities across the full staff population.

18.2. Training programmes shall, so far as practicable, be scheduled and delivered in a manner that accommodates staff with caring responsibilities and staff with disabilities, including through the provision of recordings, flexible scheduling, or remote participation options.

18.3. The University shall track participation in professional development opportunities by sex and by unit, and shall address any pattern of unequal access identified through that monitoring.

18.4. Financial or logistical barriers, such as the cost of travel to a conference or the unavailability of childcare during a training event, shall not be allowed to become an unaddressed source of unequal access to professional development, and staff facing such barriers may request assistance from their structural subdivision or the Human Resources Department.

Article 19. Work-Life Balance and Family Support

19.1. The University recognises that the ability to combine professional responsibilities with family life is essential to genuine equality of

opportunity, and shall apply national legislation on maternity, paternity and parental leave in a manner that fully respects the rights of staff.

19.2. Staff returning from maternity, paternity or extended parental leave shall be reinstated to an equivalent position and shall not be disadvantaged in subsequent performance evaluation, promotion or training decisions because of that leave.

19.3. The University shall, within available resources, explore measures such as on-campus childcare support, breastfeeding facilities, and flexible scheduling of meetings and mandatory events to accommodate staff and students with young children.

19.4. The University shall, where practicable, avoid scheduling mandatory meetings, examinations or key academic events at times that make it unreasonably difficult for staff or students with documented caring responsibilities to participate, and shall consider alternative arrangements upon reasoned request submitted in advance.

19.5. A member of staff or a student who is a single parent, or who bears primary responsibility for the care of a dependent relative with a disability or serious illness, may request individualised adjustments to their teaching schedule, examination timetable or work assignments, which shall be considered in good faith by the relevant manager or academic unit.

Article 20. Flexible Working Arrangements

20.1. Where the nature of the role permits, the University shall consider requests for flexible working arrangements, including adjusted hours or remote work for defined periods, from staff with disabilities, caring responsibilities, or other circumstances warranting such consideration.

20.2. Requests for flexible working arrangements shall be considered on their individual merits, in a transparent and documented manner, and any refusal shall be accompanied by a written explanation of the operational reasons for that refusal.

20.3. A staff member whose request for flexible working arrangements is refused may ask the Human Resources Department to review the decision, and may raise the matter with the Equal Opportunities Committee if they believe the refusal was influenced by a protected characteristic rather than genuine operational need.

PART V. EQUAL OPPORTUNITIES IN EDUCATION AND STUDENT LIFE

Article 21. Equal Access to Admission

21.1. Admission to the University's educational programmes shall be based on academic merit, aptitude and, where applicable, the results of state examinations and competitive selection procedures, applied equally to all applicants regardless of protected characteristics.

21.2. The University shall ensure that admission information, application procedures and entrance examinations are accessible to applicants with disabilities, including through the provision of accessible formats, additional time where appropriate, and physically accessible examination venues.

21.3. The University shall monitor the composition of its applicant pool and admitted cohorts by sex, region of origin, and, where appropriate and lawful, other relevant characteristics, in order to identify and address any unexplained pattern of underrepresentation.

21.4. Where a particular faculty or specialisation shows a persistent and substantial gender imbalance among applicants, the University, through the faculty concerned and the Women's Advisory Board, shall consider targeted outreach to schools and colleges to encourage a broader range of applicants to consider that field of study.

Article 22. Accessible Learning Infrastructure

22.1. To ensure equal access to education, the University provides tailored support for students from diverse backgrounds. This includes accessible learning infrastructure, such as ramps, adapted restrooms,

accessible signage, and, where feasible, adapted classroom furniture and assistive technology for students with sensory or mobility impairments.

22.2. New construction and major renovation projects on University premises shall incorporate accessibility standards from the design stage, and the University shall maintain a rolling programme to improve the accessibility of existing buildings, prioritised according to student need.

22.3. Academic materials, including lecture handouts, reading lists and examination papers, shall be made available in accessible formats upon request to students with visual, hearing or other relevant impairments, and academic staff shall receive guidance on preparing accessible teaching materials.

22.4. Students and staff with disabilities shall be consulted, through the support units described in Article 24 and the Equal Opportunities Committee, on the prioritisation of accessibility investment, so that improvements are targeted at the barriers that most affect their daily participation in University life rather than determined solely by administrative convenience.

Article 23. Scholarships and Financial Support

23.1. The University administers social scholarship programmes intended to ensure that talented students are not prevented from completing their studies because of financial hardship, including support directed at orphans, students from low-income households, students with disabilities, and students from remote or rural areas.

23.2. Criteria for the award of scholarships and financial support shall be published and applied transparently, and shall be reviewed periodically by the Student Affairs Office in consultation with the Equal Opportunities

Committee to ensure that they continue to reach the students most in need of support.

23.3. The University shall, so far as resources allow, seek external and donor funding to expand the scope of social scholarship and hardship-support programmes available to students.

23.4. A student who experiences a sudden change in financial circumstances during the academic year, including as a result of the loss of a parent or guardian, family illness, or a natural disaster affecting their household, may apply for emergency hardship support through the Student Affairs Office, considered outside the ordinary scholarship cycle.

Article 24. Support Units for Students with Special Needs

24.1. The University maintains designated support units for students with special needs or those requiring socio-economic assistance, staffed by personnel trained in disability support, psychological counselling, and social work as appropriate.

24.2. These support units shall assess, in consultation with the individual student, what reasonable accommodations are appropriate to that student's circumstances, which may include extended examination time, alternative assessment formats, note-taking assistance, priority course registration, or adapted accommodation in University dormitories.

24.3. Students shall be informed of the existence and services of these support units at the point of admission and throughout their studies, through orientation materials, the University website, and academic advising.

24.4. Where a student's disability or health condition requires arrangements extending beyond the University's own facilities, such as

specialised medical equipment or off-campus therapeutic services, the support units shall assist the student in identifying, and where possible coordinating with, appropriate external providers, in cooperation with the student's family where the student consents to their involvement.

Article 25. Support for Socio-Economically Disadvantaged Students

25.1. The University recognises that socio-economic disadvantage can compound other forms of inequality, and shall take this into account in the design of its outreach, admissions support, and financial aid programmes.

25.2. The University shall, where practicable, conduct outreach activities in underserved districts and rural areas of the Surkhandarya region to raise awareness of admission opportunities, scholarship programmes, and preparatory courses among prospective students who might not otherwise consider higher education accessible to them.

25.3. Dormitory allocation and subsidised meal programmes shall give appropriate priority to students facing demonstrated financial hardship, applying transparent and consistently administered criteria.

25.4. The University shall cooperate with local mahalla committees, secondary schools and regional education authorities in the Surkhandarya region to identify talented prospective students from disadvantaged households at an early stage, so that preparatory support can begin well before the admission process itself.

Article 26. Equal Opportunities in Assessment and Academic Progression

26.1. Examinations, coursework and other forms of assessment shall be designed and marked according to clear, published academic criteria

applied equally to all students, and academic staff shall receive guidance on avoiding unconscious bias in grading and academic supervision.

26.2. Where a student's disability or other relevant circumstance affects their ability to demonstrate their knowledge under standard assessment conditions, the University shall provide reasonable adjustments to the assessment format or conditions, without lowering the academic standard being assessed.

26.3. Decisions on academic progression, including dismissal for academic failure, shall be taken through documented, consistent procedures, and a student who believes that a decision was affected by discrimination shall have access to the grievance procedure described in Part VIII of this Policy.

26.4. A student who requires an extended period of absence for reasons connected with pregnancy, childbirth, serious illness or a comparable protected circumstance shall be entitled to apply for academic leave and reinstatement on terms that do not penalise them, so far as reasonably possible, for the interruption in their studies.

PART VI. NON-DISCRIMINATION AND ANTI-HARASSMENT

Article 27. Prohibition of Discrimination

27.1. Discrimination against any member of the University community on the grounds of a protected characteristic, whether direct or indirect, is strictly prohibited in every area of University activity described in Article 2.

27.2. It shall be considered discrimination for these purposes to instruct, pressure or encourage another person to discriminate, and any person who does so shall be subject to the disciplinary measures described in Article 38.

27.3. A measure that treats persons differently in order to correct a demonstrated and persistent disadvantage experienced by an underrepresented group, adopted transparently and proportionately in accordance with this Policy, shall not be regarded as unlawful discrimination.

27.4. A genuine occupational or academic requirement that is objectively justified by the nature of a particular role or programme of study, and that is proportionate to a legitimate aim, shall not be regarded as discriminatory merely because it has a differential effect on persons with a particular protected characteristic.

Article 28. Prohibition of Harassment and Bullying

28.1. Harassment, bullying and other conduct that violates the dignity of a member of the University community, or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading or offensive environment, is strictly prohibited, whether it occurs on University premises, during University-organised activities off-campus, or through electronic communication and social media associated with University functions.

28.2. Harassment may take the form of a single serious incident or a pattern of less serious incidents over time, and the University will treat both forms with equal seriousness under the procedures described in Part VIII of this Policy.

28.3. Academic staff shall exercise particular care in the exercise of authority over students and junior colleagues, given the inherent imbalance of power in supervisory and evaluative relationships, and shall refrain from any conduct that could reasonably be perceived as an abuse of that authority.

28.4. The University recognises that bullying and harassment can occur through digital channels, including messaging applications, social media and online learning platforms used for academic or administrative purposes, and this Policy applies with equal force to conduct occurring in such digital environments as it does to conduct occurring in person on campus.

28.5. Group conduct, including hazing or initiation practices directed at new students by more senior students, shall be treated as a form of bullying where it involves humiliation, coercion or exclusion connected with a protected characteristic, and shall be addressed under the procedures of this Policy in addition to any separate disciplinary code governing student conduct.

Article 29. Sexual Harassment

29.1. Sexual harassment, including unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favours, and other unwanted verbal, non-verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature, is strictly prohibited, and the University treats it as a serious disciplinary matter.

29.2. A person's professional or academic future, including grades, recommendations, employment decisions or contract renewal, shall never be made conditional, explicitly or implicitly, upon the toleration of or submission to conduct of a sexual nature.

29.3. Complaints of sexual harassment shall be handled with particular sensitivity and confidentiality, in accordance with the procedures described in Article 35 through Article 37, and complainants shall be offered access to psychological or counselling support through the Student Affairs Office or the Human Resources Department, as appropriate.

29.4. Pending the outcome of an investigation into a serious allegation of sexual harassment, the University may take interim measures, such as adjusting supervision arrangements, seating, or physical proximity between the parties, in order to protect the complainant and preserve the integrity of the investigation, without those measures themselves constituting a presumption of guilt.

Article 30. Victimization and Retaliation

30.1. No person shall be subjected to retaliation, victimisation, or any adverse treatment because they have, in good faith, raised a concern, made a complaint, provided evidence, or otherwise participated in a process under this Policy.

30.2. An allegation of retaliation shall be treated as a serious matter in its own right, investigated under the same procedures as the underlying complaint, and, where substantiated, shall result in disciplinary measures independent of the outcome of the original complaint.

30.3. A complaint made in good faith that is not ultimately substantiated shall not, of itself, expose the complainant to any adverse consequence;

this protection does not extend to a complaint made in bad faith or with knowledge of its falsity.

30.4. Protection against retaliation extends to witnesses and to any other person who assists in an investigation under this Policy, including a person who provides a supporting statement, translates for a complainant, or accompanies a complainant to a meeting.

PART VII. REASONABLE ACCOMMODATION AND ACCESSIBILITY

Article 31. Reasonable Accommodation for Persons with Disabilities

31.1. The University shall provide reasonable accommodation to students, staff and applicants with disabilities, to enable them to participate on an equal basis with others in all aspects of University life, unless doing so would impose a disproportionate or undue burden on the University.

31.2. A request for accommodation may be made to the support units described in Article 24, the Human Resources Department, or a person's direct academic or line manager, and shall be considered promptly, in consultation with the person concerned and, where relevant and with appropriate consent, medical or specialist advice.

31.3. The University shall keep a confidential record of accommodations provided, to ensure continuity of support as a student or staff member moves between courses, departments or academic years.

31.4. A determination that a requested accommodation would impose a disproportionate or undue burden shall be made only after genuine consideration of alternatives, shall be documented in writing with reasons, and may be reviewed by the Equal Opportunities Committee at the request of the person concerned.

Article 32. Physical Accessibility of Campus

32.1. The University shall maintain and progressively improve the physical accessibility of its buildings, grounds, transport and dormitories, in accordance with the rolling accessibility programme described in Article 22.

32.2. Accessibility audits of University premises shall be conducted periodically, with the involvement of students and staff with disabilities, and the results shall inform the prioritisation of accessibility investment.

32.3. University-organised transport between campus buildings, dormitories and off-campus placements shall, so far as practicable, be accessible to students and staff with mobility impairments, and alternative arrangements shall be made available where a particular vehicle or route is not accessible.

Article 33. Digital Accessibility

33.1. The University's website, learning management systems, and digital communication tools shall, so far as practicable, comply with recognised digital accessibility standards, so that they can be used by students and staff with visual, hearing, motor or cognitive impairments.

33.2. Staff responsible for producing digital content, including course materials and administrative announcements, shall receive guidance on basic digital accessibility practices, such as the use of descriptive text for images and accessible document formats.

33.3. Where the University adopts new digital platforms for teaching, examination or administration, accessibility for users with disabilities shall be one of the criteria considered in the selection and configuration of those platforms, alongside cost, functionality and security.

PART VIII. REPORTING, GRIEVANCE AND INVESTIGATION

Article 34. Reporting Channels

34.1. A person who believes they have experienced or witnessed discrimination, harassment or victimisation may report the matter through any of the following channels: their immediate academic or line manager; the Human Resources Department; the Student Affairs Office; the Women's Advisory Board; the Equal Opportunities Committee; or a confidential reporting channel maintained by the University for this purpose.

34.2. Reports may be made in writing or orally, and a person supporting a complainant, including a fellow student, colleague, or trade union representative, may assist in preparing or presenting the report.

34.3. The University shall ensure that information about reporting channels is prominently displayed on its website, in student and staff handbooks, and in dormitories and common areas, in clear and accessible language.

34.4. A report may, where the complainant wishes, be made anonymously; the University will take what action is reasonably possible in response to an anonymous report, while noting that anonymity may limit the extent of the investigation that can be conducted.

34.5. The University shall ensure that international students, exchange students and staff who are not fluent in the State language have access to reporting channels and support in a language they understand, including through interpretation arranged by the relevant international cooperation unit of the University.

34.6. A person with a disability that affects communication shall be offered appropriate assistance, such as sign-language interpretation or the involvement of a support person, in order to make a report and participate fully in any resulting process.

Article 35. Grievance Procedure

35.1. Upon receipt of a report under Article 34, the recipient shall acknowledge receipt promptly and, unless the matter is resolved informally to the satisfaction of the complainant, shall refer it to the Equal Opportunities Committee or the Human Resources Department, as appropriate to the nature of the complaint.

35.2. Minor concerns may, with the agreement of the complainant, be addressed through informal resolution, including mediation or a direct conversation facilitated by a manager or the Student Affairs Office.

35.3. Where informal resolution is not appropriate or does not succeed, the matter shall proceed to formal investigation under Article 36. The complainant shall be kept informed, at reasonable intervals, of the progress of their case.

35.4. The University shall aim to conclude the grievance procedure, from initial report to final decision, within sixty calendar days, save in cases of particular complexity, in which case the complainant and respondent shall be informed of the reasons for any extension.

Article 36. Investigation Process

36.1. Formal investigations shall be conducted by, or under the supervision of, a person or panel without a direct personal or professional conflict of interest in the matter, appointed by the Equal Opportunities Committee or the Human Resources Department as appropriate.

36.2. Both the complainant and the respondent shall have the opportunity to present their account of events, submit relevant evidence, and, where appropriate, respond to the evidence presented by the other party, before any finding is made.

36.3. Findings shall be based on the balance of probabilities, that is, on whether it is more likely than not that the conduct complained of occurred, and shall be documented in a written report setting out the evidence considered and the reasons for the conclusion reached.

36.4. Both parties shall be informed in writing of the outcome of the investigation and of any right of appeal, in accordance with Article 39.

36.5. Investigators shall receive training in fair and trauma-informed investigative technique, so that complainants and witnesses are treated with sensitivity while respondents receive a genuinely fair hearing consistent with the principles of natural justice.

Article 37. Confidentiality

37.1. Information relating to a complaint, investigation or outcome under this Policy shall be shared only with those persons who need to know it in order to conduct a fair and effective process, and shall otherwise be treated as strictly confidential.

37.2. Personal data collected during a grievance procedure shall be processed and stored in accordance with applicable data-protection legislation and shall be retained only for as long as necessary for the purposes of the procedure and any subsequent appeal or legal process.

37.3. Confidentiality obligations under this Article do not prevent the University from taking necessary interim measures to protect the safety or

wellbeing of a complainant or other members of the University community while an investigation is ongoing.

37.4. Aggregate, anonymised statistics derived from complaints handled under this Policy may be used for the monitoring and reporting purposes described in Articles 40 and 41, provided that no individual can reasonably be identified from the information published.

Article 38. Disciplinary Measures

38.1. Where an investigation substantiates a complaint of discrimination, harassment or victimisation, the University shall apply disciplinary measures proportionate to the severity and circumstances of the conduct, ranging from a formal warning to termination of employment or expulsion, in accordance with the University's Code of Ethics, Internal Personnel Regulations, and applicable labour and education legislation.

38.2. In determining the appropriate disciplinary measure, the University shall take into account the severity and duration of the conduct, any imbalance of power between the parties, the respondent's prior disciplinary record, and any mitigating or aggravating circumstances.

38.3. Where a substantiated complaint discloses conduct that may constitute a criminal offence, the University shall, in accordance with applicable law and with due regard to the wishes of the complainant, inform the complainant of their right to pursue the matter with the competent state authorities.

38.4. Disciplinary measures imposed under this Article shall be recorded in the respondent's personnel or student file in accordance with the University's ordinary record-keeping rules, and shall be taken into account in any subsequent disciplinary matter involving the same person.

Article 39. Appeals

39.1. A complainant or a respondent who is dissatisfied with the outcome of an investigation, or with a disciplinary measure imposed, may appeal to the Rectorate, or to such appellate body as the Rectorate may designate, within fourteen calendar days of being notified of the outcome.

39.2. An appeal shall be considered by a person or panel not involved in the original investigation or decision, and shall be limited to consideration of whether the original process was fair and the conclusion reasonably supported by the evidence, unless new and material evidence has come to light.

39.3. The decision on appeal shall be final within the University's internal procedures, without prejudice to any right the parties may have to pursue the matter before the competent state authorities or courts.

39.4. The lodging of an appeal shall not, of itself, suspend any interim protective measure put in place under Article 29.4 or Article 37.3, unless the body considering the appeal decides otherwise.

PART IX. MONITORING, TRAINING AND IMPLEMENTATION

Article 40. Monitoring and Data Collection

40.1. The University regularly monitors the representation and engagement of different groups through participation data and survey feedback, covering areas including admissions, enrolment and completion rates, staff recruitment and promotion, salary distribution, participation in training and international mobility programmes, and the number and outcome of complaints handled under this Policy.

40.2. Data collected for monitoring purposes shall be disaggregated, where lawful and appropriate, by sex, disability status, and other relevant characteristics, and shall be aggregated and anonymised before being used in reports or published externally, so as to protect individual privacy.

40.3. The Equal Opportunities Committee shall be responsible for coordinating the collection, quality assurance and analysis of this data, in cooperation with the Human Resources Department, the Student Affairs Office, and the University's planning and statistics unit.

40.4. Findings from the monitoring described in this Article shall be presented, in appropriately anonymised form, to the Academic Council at least once per academic year, so that the University's principal academic governance body is directly informed of progress and remaining challenges rather than receiving this information only indirectly.

40.5. Where monitoring data reveals a persistent disparity affecting a particular group, the relevant structural subdivision shall be asked to propose, within a reasonable period, specific measures to address that disparity, and the Equal Opportunities Committee shall track the implementation of those measures.

Article 41. Annual Reporting

41.1. These measures are integrated into the University's annual institutional reports, which are considered by the Rectorate and the Academic Council, and which shall include a dedicated section on the implementation of this Policy.

41.2. The annual report shall summarise the data described in Article 40, describe the activities of the Equal Opportunities Committee and the Women's Advisory Board during the reporting period, and set out recommendations for the following year's equal-opportunities work plan.

41.3. A public-facing summary of the annual report, omitting confidential or personally identifiable information, shall be made available to the University community and, where appropriate, published on the University's website.

41.4. The annual report shall include an assessment of progress against the objectives set out in Article 1 and the targets adopted in the preceding year's work plan, so that the University community can judge the University's performance year over year rather than reviewing isolated figures without context.

Article 42. Training and Awareness-Raising

42.1. The University shall provide regular training on equal opportunities, non-discrimination and the prevention of harassment to all new staff as part of induction, and to existing staff and students on a periodic basis thereafter.

42.2. Training for managers, academic supervisors and members of selection and disciplinary panels shall include specific modules on

unconscious bias, fair recruitment practice, and the proper handling of complaints under this Policy.

42.3. The University shall organise periodic awareness-raising campaigns, seminars and events, including in cooperation with the Women's Advisory Board and student organisations, to strengthen the University community's understanding of, and commitment to, the principles set out in this Policy.

42.4. Completion of mandatory equal-opportunities training shall be recorded in each staff member's personnel file, and heads of structural subdivisions shall ensure that staff under their supervision complete such training within the timeframe set by the Human Resources Department.

42.5. Training materials shall be reviewed periodically to ensure that they remain accurate, relevant to the University's own experience, and reflective of current legislation and good practice, and shall wherever possible include practical case studies drawn from the higher-education context.

Article 43. International Cooperation and Benchmarking

43.1. The University shall draw on its international partnerships and cooperation agreements to exchange good practice in equal-opportunities policy and to benchmark its own performance against comparable institutions.

43.2. Where appropriate, the University shall seek the participation of staff and students in international training, conferences and networks focused on gender equality, disability inclusion, and diversity in higher education, and shall disseminate lessons learned from such participation within the University.

43.3. When negotiating new international partnership, exchange or double-degree agreements, the University's International Cooperation Department shall have regard to the equal-opportunities standards and practices of prospective partner institutions as one factor in assessing the overall suitability and value of the partnership.

PART X. FINAL PROVISIONS

Article 44. Communication and Dissemination

44.1. This Policy shall be published on the University's official website, distributed to all new staff and students as part of orientation and induction, and made available in print at the offices of the Human Resources Department, the Student Affairs Office and the Equal Opportunities Committee.

44.2. By embedding these values into its governance structure, the University ensures that equality is not merely a statement of intent but an actionable component of its institutional strategy, contributing to a fair and diverse academic environment.

44.3. The University shall ensure that this Policy is available in the languages of instruction used at the University, so that all students and staff can understand their rights and responsibilities under it.

44.4. The University's external communications, including its website, promotional materials and social media presence, shall reflect the diversity of its student and staff community and shall avoid imagery or language that reinforces stereotypes about who can succeed in higher education or in a particular field of study.

44.5. Heads of structural subdivisions shall display information about this Policy and the available reporting channels in a visible location within their premises, including common rooms, dormitories, libraries and laboratories, in a format accessible to persons with visual impairments where practicable.

Article 45. Relationship with Other Policies

45.1. This Policy shall be read together with the University's Code of Ethics and Internal Personnel Regulations, its Charter, its internal labour regulations, and any other University policy touching upon recruitment, student welfare, disciplinary procedure, or health and safety.

45.2. Where a specific procedural matter, such as the conduct of disciplinary hearings or the handling of personal data, is governed in greater detail by another University policy, that policy shall apply, provided that it is not inconsistent with the principles established in this Policy.

45.3. Where the University adopts a separate, more detailed policy specifically addressing accessibility, prevention of sexual harassment, or another matter within the scope of this Policy, that separate policy shall be read as elaborating, and not replacing, the general commitments set out here, and any inconsistency shall be resolved in favour of the standard most protective of equal treatment.

Article 46. Review and Amendment

46.1. This Policy shall be reviewed by the Equal Opportunities Committee not less than once every three years, or sooner if warranted by changes in legislation, significant findings from the monitoring described in Article 40, or a reasoned request from the Rectorate, the Women's Advisory Board, or student or staff representative bodies.

46.2. Any proposed amendment shall be developed in consultation with the Women's Advisory Board, relevant staff and student representatives, and shall be submitted to the Academic Council and the Rectorate for approval before taking effect.

46.3. Prior to each periodic review, the Equal Opportunities Committee shall solicit feedback from students and staff through surveys, focus groups or other appropriate consultation mechanisms, and shall summarise that feedback in the material submitted to the Academic Council and the Rectorate.

46.4. A revised version of this Policy shall retain a visible record of its approval and amendment history, so that the University community can identify which version of the Policy applied at any given time and can trace how its provisions have evolved.

Article 47. Entry into Force

47.1. This Policy shall enter into force upon its approval by the Academic Council and the Rectorate of Termez State University, and shall remain in effect until superseded or repealed by a subsequent decision of those bodies.

47.2. All heads of structural subdivisions of the University shall take the measures necessary to bring this Policy to the attention of staff and students under their supervision within thirty calendar days of its entry into force.

47.3. Existing internal regulations, job descriptions, admission procedures and other University instruments shall be reviewed for consistency with this Policy within six months of its entry into force, and any necessary amendments shall be proposed to the appropriate approving body within that period.

47.4. The Equal Opportunities Committee shall report to the Rectorate on the state of this transitional review within six months of the Policy's entry into force, identifying any instrument still requiring amendment and the proposed timeline for completing that work.

Approved by

Rector, Termez State University

Chair, Academic Council, Termez State University

Termez, Republic of Uzbekistan